



MONTHLY UPDATE

China activities: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-31 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

16 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · CAPE VERDE · CHAD · DR CONGO · ETHIOPIA · GABON · KENYA ·
NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SOUTH SUDAN · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The country was named a [founding member, from 16 July, of a 29-country artificial-intelligence organisation headquartered in Shanghai](#). No instrument of accession, obligation, contribution or programme of work is on the record here.

Botswana

China's ambassador [publicly offered AI cooperation in smart mining, digital government and talent training, pitching Chinese AI technology as a lever for economic diversification and pointing to a July 2026 pledge of 5,000 AI training places for developing countries and AI application cooperation centres for bodies including the African Union](#). It is an offer rather than an instrument: no Botswanan response, memorandum or programme is on file.

Burkina Faso

The month's only Chinese item is an approach rather than an agreement: the communications minister and a Burkinabe delegation were [received at a Chinese broadcaster's Beijing headquarters on 22 August 2026 to examine partnership in audiovisual and digital broadcasting, the exchanges going to the terms of collaboration with the national broadcaster and the national transmission company](#). No memorandum, commitment, value or timetable is stated.

Cape Verde

On 29 July the Prime Minister and Finance Minister received a Huawei delegation, reviewed what the government describes as a strategic ICT partnership and were introduced to a new country representative. No agreement, project, sum or timetable was named; what the account records is access and continuity rather than a transaction. The last dated Chinese technology commitment the wiki holds for Cape Verde closed in 2021.

Chad

The financing that did arrive in the window came from one partner. Chad and China [signed two grant agreements totalling 300 million yuan, in tranches of 100 million and 200 million](#) that the minister of state called immediately mobilisable, for infrastructure and social development with digital technologies supported alongside; and earlier in the week the Chinese ambassador [announced 5,000 scholarships in technology and artificial intelligence](#). Neither carries a project list, a digital allocation or a timetable, and the local-currency equivalents in circulation differ between outlets on their own conversion dates.

DR Congo

On 3 July a memorandum was signed with a Chinese supplier for a [2,100 km route – 1,700 km along the Congo River plus nearly 400 km terrestrial – at a stated US\\$1.5bn, with more than US\\$400m required for the first phase](#). Both figures are company-reported, and there is no financing close, contract or works.

Ethiopia

Ethio Telecom and Huawei were reported on 15 and 17 July to be widening a network-equipment relationship into cloud, AI, cybersecurity, IoT, data-centre services and digital platforms for enterprises and small businesses, with mobile-money integration for payments and e-commerce. It is explicitly scoping rather than an executed agreement, and no value or term is disclosed. The vendor that supplies the radio network would supply the enterprise cloud and AI layer above it.

A separate data-centre track with Inspur and Shandong was reported on 16 July.

Nothing moved on the third-operator question, on satellite licensing, or on the fibre corridor whose binding agreement was February's news.

Gabon

One of two accords signed on 14 July on the margins of the open-innovation programme's launch was with an equipment supplier, to create smart rooms, deliver training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and supply its certifying training kits ([account of both accords](#)); its terms were not published – no room count, trainee target, cost or duration.

Kenya

The e-commerce cooperation memorandum with China was [cited as the basis for dispatching eighteen ICT officers to Shandong](#), framed inside the digital master plan. The memorandum's signature date, terms and text are not held.

Namibia

The President met a vendor's executives in Shenzhen on 7 July and urged the company to create artificial-intelligence jobs and skills for Namibians; the Presidency acknowledged a Chinese contribution of CNY 98,000,000 to the Windhoek smart-city pilot, given by the source as about US\$14.4m in 2026 ([Presidency account](#)).

Niger

China's newly arrived ambassador [met the vendor's vice-president to discuss deepening cooperation](#). The vendor has operated in Niger since 1998 and a [2014 export-credit loan of RMB 623.7m built a 2,275 km domestic fibre backbone completed in 2017](#); no Chinese financing or vendor contract after 2017 is on record.

Nigeria

On 27 August Huawei launched an agentic artificial-intelligence cloud in Nigeria at its own Lagos summit, running on local cloud infrastructure it offers with data residency, security, compliance and low-latency claims for finance, telecommunications, internet services, government and enterprises. The technology development agency's director-general used the platform to set out the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative as the route from consuming technology to leading African cloud and artificial-intelligence innovation, and the Lagos deputy governor said the state is building the digital foundations for artificial intelligence rather than waiting for it.

Sovereignty language attaching to a foreign vendor's platform is the pattern here rather than the exception: the same company's [Lagos innovation centre opened in May 2025 to a ministerial framing as a catalyst for the country's technology sovereignty](#). No customer, contract, capacity or price is stated for the cloud launch, and the residency and compliance claims are the vendor's own.

Senegal

The sovereign cloud is [in testing, with data-centre infrastructure deployed and verified for redundancy and reliability to host sensitive national data on Senegalese territory](#), accelerated ahead of an international sporting event. No contract, value, hosting term, exit arrangement or data-access terms are reported — a sovereignty claim resting on a vendor relationship whose terms are not held.

South Sudan

On 31 August the ICT minister was reported to have [held exploratory talks with a Huawei vice-president in Hangzhou, on the sidelines of a China-Africa digital capacity building conference](#), saying the government is ready to seek the company's expertise in connecting public services. Beyond e-governance, participation is sought in building smart cities, providing energy solutions and setting up a national data hub in Juba.

This is a repair, not an opening. Government officials accused the company in 2014 of hacking government emails and forging documents; it stayed in the market through the rift, connecting schoolchildren to the internet and refurbishing school laboratories, and the restoration is credited to two officials who took post in 2025, whose [meeting in Juba in early 2026 covered the digital divide, the data hub and a smart capital](#). Nothing has been agreed: no contract, memorandum, workstream or figure is on record, which is where this relationship stood in February and where it still stands.

Zambia

A [seminar on China-Zambia artificial-intelligence cooperation](#) covered localising artificial-intelligence solutions to Zambian conditions and partnering with universities on curricula, and a ministry director and the Chinese ambassador [discussed digital infrastructure, emerging technologies, skills and research](#). No agreement, value, timetable or named institution follows from either.

Zimbabwe

A Harare forum [argued that cooperation with China will help African countries build technological capability](#), with the terms of technology transfer the point at issue. The account is carried by Chinese state media, which is part of what it evidences. No project, transfer arrangement or commitment is named in it, so it records an argument about the relationship rather than a movement within it.

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